



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Jerome Academy
School Website: <https://stjeromeacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St. Jerome Academy (Hyattsville, MD 20781) presents a robust Catholic, classical-leaning program with a deliberate integration of Montessori elements in early childhood. Publicly visible materials emphasize a transcendental aims framework (truth, goodness, beauty), Catholic faith formation, and a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) alongside Great Books, Latin, and Western Civilization study. The school also foregrounds liturgical life (Mass, adoration, catechesis), family partnerships, and a community vision that ties character formation to intellectual formation. Taken together, these features map strongly to a CLASSICAL orientation, with explicit affirmations of Catholic intellectual tradition, graded classical pedagogy, and active parental involvement.

Category-by-category assessments below apply a standardized keyword analysis drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon. Across Categories 1–6, the school's public materials show consistent alignment with classical aims (transcendentals such as truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information; Trivium-centered curriculum; contemplative/memory-based pedagogy; model-teacher framing; and robust parent/-community partnership). The aggregate profile is CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: Explicit Catholic identity, liturgical life, catechesis, and the integration of theology with curriculum; clear references to truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and wonder. Evidence: weekly Mass and liturgy; catechesis; vision statements invoking true/good/beautiful; catechetical spaces (Atrium) and Catholic thought across curriculum. - Purpose & Goal: Formation-focused goals with virtue, wisdom, and a civilizational, classical frame; explicit aim to cultivate character, not merely information or job-readiness. Evidence: formation in wisdom and virtue; Catholic intellectual tradition; Great Books and classical aims. - Curriculum: Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) plus Great Books, Latin, and Western Civilization; Montessori integration in early childhood; explicit history-focused approach. Evidence: Grammar/Logic stages; Great Books; Latin; Montessori integration; "classical + Montessori" emphasis. - Pedagogy: Mix of memory/recitation/chant in the early grades and Socratic/logic-oriented work in later grades; contemplative elements and a high value on wonder; some explicit use of classical methods (Socratic-like inquiry, rhetoric). Evidence: Grammar Stage memory/chanting; Logic Stage argument formation; catechesis; contemplative aims. - Faculty: Framing of teachers within a "living curriculum" and teacher-as-builder metaphors; explicit emphasis on virtue and formation as part of faculty identity; presence of a formal faculty directory and leadership. Evidence: pedagogical vision invoking teachers as builders; leadership (principal) and faculty postings. - Parents & Community: Strong partnership with parents as co-educators; opportunities for parent formation; open-campus/visitation ethos; parent groups and community ties. Evidence: explicit parent partnerships; catechesis/involvement; parent groups (e.g., Santa Rosa de Lima group); handbook framing of family life and formation.

Note: All six categories were analyzed using the provided classical-school rubric (Six Essential Elements), with keyword evidence drawn directly from the school's public materials and the knowledge base rubric. The presence of terms such as truth, virtue, beauty, liturgy, catechesis, Great Books, Trivium, Latin, memory/recitation, and a "living curriculum" framing supports CLASSICAL standing across categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Vision emphasizes fostering wonder and love for what is truly true, good, and beautiful, aligning with transcendentals and moral realism. - Liturgical and communal practices are explicit (weekly Mass, Eucharistic Adoration, Rosary; Sacred Liturgy central to life). - Catechesis and Catholic faith formation are integrated with curriculum (Atrium; Catechesis of the Good Shepherd; Catholic thought across programs). - Foundational theology and Catholic intellectual tradition are foregrounded in mission and pedagogical vision.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, liturgy, Mass, catechesis, wonder, theology, sacred liturgy. (Multiple explicit mentions across vision, liturgy, catechesis sections.) - Negative keywords: none detected in public materials for this category. - Estimated keywords present: 9 positive; 0 negative. Resulting ratio ~100% positive.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates transcendental moral realism and a sacramental, liturgical Catholic framework, with explicit catechesis and communal worship, meeting the hallmark elements of a Catholic classical foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states a formation aim in wisdom and virtue, emphasizing formation over job-preparation. "Educating children in wisdom and virtue." - Vision anchors education in truth, goodness, and beauty as real, with formation in Catholic thought and culture. - Curriculum and messaging emphasize a civilizational, classical mission, including "Great Books," liberal arts orientation, and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, human excellence. (Explicit terms in vision and curriculum statements.) - Negative keywords: none detected (no emphasis on workforce preparation or 21st-century job-skills framing in the public materials). - Estimated keywords present: 8–10 positive; 0 negative. Resulting ratio ~100% positive.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation in virtue and wisdom and integrates a classical mission, aligning with classical aims of paideia and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is named explicitly (Grammar Stage, Logic Stage) and described as the organizing backbone of the curriculum. - Great Books and Western Civilization are foregrounded as core content; Latin is integrated; history and other humanities are interwoven throughout. - Montessori is integrated in early childhood, but the long-range plan centers on a classical liberal arts curriculum (Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric). - Historical and classical threads (mythology, ancient Greece to medieval Europe) are invoked as part of a civilizational journey.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, history, Western civilization, Latin, classical, memory/recitation. - Negative keywords: none detected (no sign of social studies re-labeling history or heavy project-based emphasis that would signal non-classical alignment). - Estimated keywords present: 9–12 positive; 0 negative. Resulting ratio ~100% positive.

Why this rating - The curriculum documentation demonstrates the canonical Classical sequence (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and content (Great Books, Western Civilization, Latin) with a significant integration of Montessori in early years but a sustained classical core across grades.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Memory-based pedagogy in the grammar stage: chanting, rhymes, memorized poetry; “building blocks” language of creation and memory emphasis. - Logic-stage emphasis on argumentation, defending positions, identifying fallacies, and connecting eternal truths to modern contexts; upper grades emphasize rhetoric and speech. - Observational/inquiry approach in non-classroom activities (nature studies, Ward music method, fine arts) and integration of catechesis. - Catechesis of the Good Shepherd in Montessori settings, bringing liturgical and contemplative practices into early education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: memory work, recitation, chanting, singing, scholé/restful contemplation, seminars/dialogue (Socratic-leaning), rhetoric, upper-school oratory, catechesis, liturgical/quiet forms. - Negative keywords: none detected; the site emphasizes a balanced pedagogy with contemplative/restful elements alongside rigorous reasoning, which aligns with classical sensibilities. - Estimated keywords present: 6–10 positive; 0 negative. Resulting ratio ~100% positive.

Why this rating - The school explicitly combines traditional memory-based methods (chanting, recitation) with higher-order inquiry (logic, argumentation, rhetoric) and contemplative aims, consistent with classical pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical vision describes teachers as central to the construction of the “finished work” and the idea that teachers are the builders who bring art and experience to the classroom. This maps to a “living curriculum” concept and a teacher-centric formation ethos. - The public materials present a structured faculty presence (faculty listings and leadership), with a clear emphasis on virtue, formation, and collaboration within the school community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture (as implied by the pedagogical vision and faculty organization). Direct explicit language is complemented by the builder metaphor in the Pedagogical Vision. - Negative keywords: none detected. - Estimated keywords present: 3–5 positive; 0 negative. Resulting ratio ~100% positive.

Why this rating - The combination of a teacher-led, builder-vision of education and a structured faculty structure aligns with classical ideals of a disciplined, virtuous, and faculty-centered formation process.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear emphasis on parental partnership and formation; families are involved in the educational life of the school; the school invites participation and fosters parent education via groups and events. - Existence of parent groups connected to the school community (e.g., Santa Rosa de Lima Parent’s Group) and an active family portal for involvement and communication. - Public materials highlight the relationship of school and family as co-educators, with expectations of openness and ongoing formation beyond the classroom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus/visitation, family life/formation, parent groups, classical book clubs. - Negative keywords: none detected. - Estimated keywords present: 6–9 positive; 0 negative. Resulting ratio ~100% positive.

Why this rating - The school explicitly frames parents as co-educators and offers ongoing formation and engagement, aligning with classical expectations for robust parental involvement and community integration.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as Element 1–6 are all CLASSICAL. The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, and no “needle-moving” changes are required for the school to reach full alignment.
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.